

SHI'AR

Empire-building alien race

SHI'AR

FACTFILE

NAME

THE SHI'AR

Enhanced strength and endurance

BASE

Chandilar (Aerie), Shi'ar Galaxy

FIRST APPEARANCE

Uncanny X-Men Vol. 1 #97
(February 1976)

IMPERIAL GUARD

CURRENT MEMBERS

AND POWERS

GLADIATOR (LEADER) Flight, enhanced strength, speed, near-invulnerability, heat vision

ASTRA Ability to phase through solid objects

ELECTRON Power over electricity and magnetism

FANG (DECEASED)

Enhanced strength, speed, and senses;

razor-sharp claws

HOBGOBLIN/SHAPESHIFTER (DECEASED)

Could assume nearly any form

IMPULSE/PULSAR Energy-based body can be released as concussive force

MIDGET/SCINTILLA Can shrink to tiny size

NIGHTSHADE/NIGHTSIDE

Can draw others into the Darkforce dimension

MAGIQUE Ability to cast illusions

MENTOR Genius-level intelligence and boosted calculating speed

ORACLE: Telepathy, precognition, and ability to fire mental blasts

QUASAR/NEUTRON

Enhanced strength and damage resistance

STARBOLT Flight, energy projection

SMASHER Enhanced strength

TEMPEST/FLASHFIRE Ability to release electrical bolts

TITAN Can grow to giant size

BASE

Chandilar (Aerie), Shi'ar Galaxy

FIRST APPEARANCE

Uncanny X-Men Vol. 1 #107
(October 1977)



Majestor D'ken failed to hold onto the Shi'ar throne.

The Shi'ar are an alien species descended from avians, who typically sport feathery hair and sometimes vestigial wings. Unlike the rival SKRULL and KREE empires, the Shi'ar Imperium consists of a patchwork of alien species, each absorbed into the empire through treaties or by force. A hereditary Majestor (male) or Majestrix (female) rules the Imperium, overseeing a High Council under the protection of the Elite Corps of the Shi'ar Imperial Guard.

CRUEL RULE

The Shi'ar are aggressive about absorbing other cultures into their empire, though the newcomers seldom receive the same rights as the Shi'ar themselves. Majestrix Lilandra has made strides to reverse this inequality, but under the leadership of Majestor D'ken, the cruel treatment of alien slaves triggered the formation of the pirates called the STARJAMMERS.

The first contact between the Shi'ar and Earth's heroes occurred when the X-MEN stopped Lilandra's brother D'ken from exploiting the powerful M'Kran crystal. Lilandra subsequently became the Majestrix of the Shi'ar Empire, briefly losing her throne to her sister DEATHBIRD until gaining it once more. Lilandra and PROFESSOR X of the X-MEN enjoyed a romantic relationship for years.

When Skrull spies fanned the flames of war between the Shi'ar and the Kree, a team of AVENGERS tried to negotiate a cessation of hostilities with Majestrix Lilandra, but they could not prevent the detonation of the nega-bomb, a Shi'ar weapon that nearly destroyed the Kree. The Shi'ar annexed vast swaths of the Kree Empire, and Deathbird served as the viceroy of the conquered territories. The



The M'Kran crystal is an artifact of immense power located on a lifeless world. It has the ability to destroy all of reality.

The X-Men have been staunch allies of Lilandra's, thanks to her romantic liaison with Professor Charles Xavier.



mind-controlling villainess Cassandra Nova later usurped Lilandra's authority, inciting violence between the Shi'ar and the X-Men. Recently, the mutant VULCAN returned to the Shi'ar Empire to avenge his mother's death. He now rules the empire and has guided it into a final war with the INHUMANS-led Kree while he simultaneously tries to exterminate Lilandra and the new Starjammers. **DW, MF**

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• *Uncanny X-Men* #107-109

The X-Men battle the Shi'ar Imperial Guard in a fight involving D'ken, Lilandra, and the M'Kran crystal.

• *New X-Men* #118-126

The "Imperial" story arc sees Cassandra Nova, the villainous genetic twin of Professor X, launching a scheme to ruin the Shi'ar empire.

